

4.4 The History Guide

www.historyguide.org

From the page, The History Guide contains the complete content of three undergraduate courses in European history which will certainly be of use to



More literary than most

those studying such topics at the college level. The History Guide contains 90 lectures in European history from ancient Sumer to the fall of Soviet-style communism in 1989. In essence, what is presented here is an online textbook in western civilisation.

The contents pane on the left lists out the topics covered, which include A Student's Guide to the Study of History, What is History?, Ancient and Medieval European History, Early Modern European History, 20th Century Europe, and more. Of course, it's all Europe, but then you do have things of interest here—the French Revolution, the Russian Revolution, the Scientific Revolution, and so on.

To use (or overuse) our favourite example—the French Revolution—here's an excerpt from the overview:

"The outbreak of the French Revolution in the summer of 1789 stirred the imagination of nearly all Europeans. The French revolutionaries—that is, those men and women who made conscious choices—sensed in their hearts and minds that they were witnessing the birth of a new age. And if the revolutionaries of Paris, Bordeaux, Lyons or Toulouse knew they were innovating, knew they were helping to usher in the dawn of a New Jerusalem, so too did observers in London, Berlin, Philadelphia, Moscow, Manchester, Geneva, Amsterdam or Boston."